

# LEAVING ON A JET PLANE

## POPULAR AIRCRAFT

Hawker (Fixed-wing aircraft)  
**₹3.5-3.75 lakh**

Falcon (Fixed-wing aircraft)  
**₹4-4.5 lakh**

Global 6000 (Fixed-wing aircraft)  
**₹6.5-7 lakh**

## STICKER PRICE/HOUR

Legacy (Fixed-wing aircraft)  
**₹4.5-5 lakh**

Bell 412 (Helicopter)  
**₹2.5-3 lakh**

Source: Industry

Several first-time charter passengers have discovered the ready availability and flexibility offered by private jets



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and international destinations opened up, people started visiting nearby destinations such as Dubai and the Maldives—marking the start of the ‘revenge travel’ season. Even as scheduled airlines have resumed all operations, the phobia of travelling on a commercial flight compels a lot of people to look for alternatives. “The trend of revenge travel is here. We have also seen an increase in demand from people who want to charter a craft to control their time,” says Amit Dutta, MD of Blade India, adding: “Today we are seeing requests coming from a much broader segment of society. Such passengers may not be chartering an aircraft every month but they are open to the concept of checking out the cost of a charter.” Companies *BT* spoke to for the story reported up to 100 per cent increase in queries for international trips after first-time travellers realised the convenience of using private jets for international travel.

These passengers are a mix of corporate clients, HNIs, celebri-



**“The absence of business class seats on regular commercial flights may have also led to passengers mindful of their privacy to charter aircraft”**

**Kanika Tekriwal**  
 CEO, JETSETGO

ties, and anyone who can afford to fly in a private aircraft. The way business owners travel now after Covid-19 is giving wings to the growth of charter flights. “Earlier, they used to travel alone or with an official delegation. But now you often find them travelling with their families on business trips,” says Rajan Mehra, CEO of Club One Air.

However, the new clientele is dominated by a higher percentage of business executives, who were earlier flying first class. “The new class of passengers has also discovered the ready availability and flexibility offered by jets,” says Group Captain Rajesh Bali, MD of Business Aircraft Operators Association (BAOA). JetSetGo’s Tekriwal segregates it further: “Of the new charter flyers, around 70 per cent would not use them again, and the balance 30 per cent are those who could afford them before Covid-19, but were not using them.” So, the market size has increased. Club One Air, the country’s largest charter service provider, claims to have retained